executing the assassination of EPRLF leader K. Padmanabha exactly a year before Rajiv Gandhi's killing.

Santhan's main task was to provide a support base for the assassins. He was part of the first batch of three operatives who reached India in September 1990. A close friend of the human bomb, Dhanu, he was seen off at Jaffna by the LTTE's intelligence chief Pottu Amman. That showed his importance in the organization. Nalini, in her confession, said that Santhan, along with Sivarasan, did not spare anyone who did not cooperate with them. A Sri Lankan national in his twenties at the time of the assassination, Santhan was a member of the intelligence wing of the LTTE and was close to Sivarasan. He was sent to Madras to continue his studies, and after coming to India, studied at the Indian Institute of Engineering & Technology in Kodabakkam, where his fees were paid by the LTTE. He was a crucial cog in the planning of Rajiv Gandhi's assassination and was one of the few conspirators who were informed early on about their target. He met Sivarasan on the day of the assassination and saw him off.[1]

The Supreme Court upheld his death sentence in May 1999. Later it was commuted to life term by the same court in February 2014 following an appeal where Santhan cited the eleven-year delay on the part of the Centre in deciding his mercy plea.

ARIVU Peraribalan (20): The bombmaker

He arranged the equipment for the bomb that was used to kill Rajiv Gandhi and carried out a location scout of former Prime Minister V.P. Singh's rally in Madras to assess security arrangements. He was just twenty years old at the time. Peraribalan was the son of a Tamil poet and had been part of the LTTE since 1989. He was involved in the sale of LTTE literature and even met LTTE chief Prabhakaran and other leaders when he went to Jaffna in 1990. He aided in the movement of LTTE cadres into India and prepared a sketch of the Vellore fort to free LTTE prisoners.[2] He had completed a diploma in electronics and communication engineering at the time of his arrest in 1991.